

YOU CAN NOW SET UP AN EFY-CERTIFIED SKILL DEVELOPMENT CENTRE IN YOUR INSTITUTION

In Partnership with EFY



Referred to as ESDC, the Centre will help students improve their hands-on skills, make exciting projects of their own and understand the latest technologies

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engineer can understand the processes and can speak about them.

Any advice for institutions wanting to prepare themselves, including their faculty, curriculum, and students for this industry?

There is a widening gap between the nature of jobs and active candidates with the skills. There is always a need for skilled and talented early-career professionals. Being in a high-end technology area, my suggestion for institutions would be to consider setting up small labs where institutions can have in-house facilities with manual or semi-automatic systems for students to have practical experience. The upcoming manufacturing units will need nine to twelve months of facility readiness; by this time the candidates can be prepared as per the requirement by giving them on-the-job training, which will help the industry and candidates both.

Consider experts from the industry for guest lectures, seminars, conferences, and workshops. We have a 'gold mine' of these from premier institutes in India. The institutes can have curriculum to develop skills that are in high demand from the semiconductor industry. They can be at graduation, masters, and doctorate levels with PhDs and also non-thesis programmes.

Independent institutes can have a dedicated certification course, which will benefit by bringing both candidates and companies closer to each other. The companies can find the right candidates and candidates can learn what the companies require.

For the final years, we can look for something like 'Enthusiastic Fresh Resources' available with incentives in form of scholarships to increase their ability to understand the subject and take it to the industry. The industry can thus save time by having a quick induction programme.

Another important point I would like to touch upon is the curriculum. It should be designed with the help of industry experts to streamline the subjects of study, which will benefit these industries. Exposure to basic knowledge and practical training from the start to the end of the fabrication process will help both students and the industry. Additionally, faculty development programmes can be conducted by industry experts. Some universities and industries can look at special awards and recognition for the professors' efforts to help address pressing engineering and supply-chain challenges as well as attract and retain top local talent.

In recent times, we do see many academic institutes and industries coming together to bridge this gap and tying up with the industry so that students can have practical training and are industry-ready. This is a good starting point for India as we move forward in semiconductor manufacturing. We need several more to bridge this gap. **EFY**